Herschel Pravin Pawar

Software Engineer specializing in Rust, and game development. My dream is to reduce barriers to building high-performance software, especially in multithreading and GPU/TPU utilization. Beyond technical work, I am committed to empowering others and fostering safe, inclusive learning environments. I write occasionally, scan the QR code for my blog!

Visit My Website

Currently based in Navi Mumbai, India (UTC+05:30 / IST)
Open to relocate - employer sponsorship required

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Education

Global Summer School
Coventry University — *CU Coventry, 8 Mile Lane, Coventry CV1 2TU, United Kingdom* — *1st July 2024 - 26th July 2024*

Bachelors of Engineering in Information Technology
University of Mumbai — *MGM College of Engineering and Technology, Kamothe, Navi Mumbai, India* — *2020 - 2024*

Higher Secondary School Certificate
Central Board of Secondary Education — *Greenfingers Global School, Kharghar, Navi Mumbai, India* — *2018 - 2020*

Secondary School Certificate
Indian Certificate of Secondary Education — *Sanjivani International School, Kharghar, Navi Mumbai, India* — *2008 - 2018*

Projects & Associations

Personal Website
Personal — *https://sakurakat.systems/posts/* — *April 2024 - Present*

- A static blog built with Astro that hosts technical posts, tutorials, and write-ups on Rust, Nix, Typst, game-dev postmortems, and site/tooling notes.
- Technical deep-dives and personal retrospectives that mix detailed implementation breakdowns with honest reflections - long-form, process-oriented posts documenting learning journeys, tool explorations, and creative projects.
- My contribution: Added the ability to author in Typst while being backwards compatible. Wrote blogposts.

Astro | Typst | Blog | Rust | Nix | Web | Game Development

Fractured Elements
Coventry University Summer School '24 Game Jam — *https://github.com/pawarherschel/CovUniGJ2024* — *July 2024*

- "Fractured Elements" is a 2D platformer developed for Coventry University's Summer School Game Jam.
- The main character changes form every few seconds and each form has a unique associated attack.
- Available to play on itch.io (https://pawarherschel.itch.io/fractured-elements)
- My contribution: Worked on game mechanics, character transitions, and attack implementations using Unity and CSharp. Placed 2nd out of 4.

Game Development | Unity | C#

Cosmos Conquerors (GMTK2023)
GMTK2023 Game Jam — *https://github.com/pawarherschel/GMTK2023* — *2023*

- A game made for the GMTK Game Jam 2023, the theme was 'Roles Reverse'.
- This is a simple game where the roles from the game Space Invaders are reversed.
- Available to play on itch.io (https://pawarherschel.itch.io/cosmos-conquerors)
- My contribution: Solo developer. Placed 4612nd out of 6703

Game Development | Godot | GDScript

Your Own Size
GameDev.tv Game Jam 2025 — *May 2025*

- Participated in GameDev.tv Game Jam 2025, the theme was 'tiny worlds'
- Collaborated with people, I was the artist for the game
- Available to play on itch.io (https://pixelcreations.itch.io/your-own-size)
- My contribution: Made a dynamic background blur shader so people can appreciate the background art, and contributed some artwork. Placed 78th out of 1010

Game Development | Godot | GLSL

Parrylord

June 2025

Bevy Jam 6

https://github.com/pawarherschel/parrylord

- Participated in ‘Bevy Jam 6’, the theme was ‘Chain Reaction’
- Learnt how to use the bevy game engine, and thus, used ECS for the game, created a leaderboard system.
- Available to play on itch.io (https://pawarherschel.itch.io/parrylord)
- My contribution: Solo Developer. Placed 61st out of 98

`Game Development` `Bevy` `Rust` `ECS`

Others

Your Own Size

May 2025

Pixel Art

https://github.com/pawarherschel/your-own-size-assets

- Assets for the game ‘Your Own Size’
- My contribution: Wood Tileset, Collectibles, itch.io page background, enemies, background art. Placed 78th out of 1010

`Pixel Art` `Your Own Size`

Fractured Elements

2024

Pixel Art

https://r2.sakurakat.systems/preview--fractured-elements-logo.pxo

- Designed logo for ‘Fractured Elements’ game within 45 minutes.
- My contribution: Conceptualized and designed the logo using Pixelorama to represent the game’s theme.

`Pixel Art` `Logo Design` `Fractured Elements` `Pixelorama`

Certificates

1st - 26th July 2024	**Certificate of Participation in Coventry University Summer Schools Games Design Programme**, Shawnna Pomeroy (Programme Manager - Summer Schools)	Coventry University, United Kingdom
1st - 26th July 2024	**Certificate of Participation in Coventry University's School of Computing, Mathematics and Data Science Summer School in Game Development**, Adam Worrallo (Head of Summer School), Faye Mitchell (Head of School), Becky Butler (Dean of College)	Coventry University, United Kingdom

Skills

Languages	English (Native) | Hindi | Marathi
Programming Languages	Rust (Intermediate) | GDScript (Beginner) | TypeScript (Beginner) | Nix (Beginner)
Systems & Tooling	Nix (Beginner) | Typst (Beginner) | Git (Beginner) | jj-vcs (Beginner) | Profiling (Beginner)
Familiar Areas	Docker (Containerization) | Cloudflare (Hosting) | NixOS (Linux) | Web Scraping | Astro (Web)